

Pogo the Proud Puffin

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Pogo was a little puffin chick.

He lived on a rocky cliff by the sea.

All the grown-up puffins could dive.

Swoosh! Into the water.

Pogo had never dived before.

He felt nervous.

His wings felt wobbly.

His tummy felt fluttery.

"What if I do it wrong?" he thought.

Papa Puffin stood beside him.

He said, "I see you feel nervous."

Pogo nodded.

"It is okay to feel nervous," Papa said.

"Trying is what makes us proud."



Then Papa told him the puffin saying.

"Proud is trying, not just winning."

"Proud is trying, not just winning," he said again.

"Proud is trying, not just winning," he said one more time.

Pogo took a deep breath.

He waddled to the edge.

One step.

Two steps.

Three steps.

And JUMP!

Splash!

Pogo was in the water.

It was cold and bubbly.
He flapped his little wings.
He paddled his little feet.
He was swimming!
He was really swimming!



"I did it!" he squawked.

Papa dived in beside him.

"You tried, and you did it!" Papa cheered.

Pogo felt proud.

Not because he was perfect.

But because he tried.

His chest felt big and warm.

His smile felt huge.

They swam together.

Around the rocks.

Under the soft waves.

The water sparkled in the sun.

Pogo caught his first tiny fish.

He felt prouder still.

Papa ruffled his wet feathers.

"You are a real diver now," Papa said.



That night, Pogo snuggled into his nest.
The sea sang below the cliff.
Shush, shush, shush.
Pogo felt nervous earlier.
Now he felt proud.
Proud of trying.
Papa tucked him in.
"You are my brave little diver," he whispered.
Pogo closed his eyes.
He was proud.
He was loved.
Goodnight, Pogo.

Moral: *Feeling proud of trying matters more than being perfect.*

The End